

Nick Kashani Motlagh

Machine Learning Researcher and Engineer | Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering

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Available now | Open to relocating

Developed machine learning methods for computer vision and natural language processing. Currently building an end-to-end document QA system. Four first-author peer-reviewed papers and a Springer **Best Paper Award**.

Education

Ohio State University

Columbus, OH

Ph.D., Computer Science and Engineering, GPA 3.70

Aug 2026

Graduate minors: Mathematics and High-Performance Computing

M.S., Computer Science and Engineering

May 2025

B.S. with Honors, Computer Science and Engineering, GPA 3.86

May 2021

Experience

Computer Engineer II

May 2025 – Present

DCS Corporation, supporting the Air Force Research Laboratory

Dayton, OH

- Developing an end-to-end document QA system intended to help maintenance engineers diagnose aircraft issues. Training small open models with LoRA on teacher-generated synthetic data for cited answers and abstention.
- Own training code, dataset generation, Slurm jobs for multi-GPU H200 training, and inference serving; debug failures and tune performance.
- Built paired-outcome pipelines for retrieval-augmented QA and trained LoRA answer/revise/abstain policies; evaluated when revision helps or harms across 25,870 held-out questions ([Return or Revise?](#), preprint).

Graduate Research Associate

Aug 2021 – Aug 2026

Computer Vision Lab, Ohio State University

Columbus, OH

- Developed per-class abstention methods ([ISVC 2022](#); [MVA 2025](#)) with 97.8% selective accuracy at 77.3% coverage on CIFAR-100; released [research code](#) and [calibration utilities](#).
- Designed [ImageCoMMuTE \(WMT 2024\)](#) to test image–translation consistency across three English-to-French model families by scoring fixed translations under matched and mismatched images.

Research Intern (graduate and undergraduate)

Summers 2020–2024

Air Force Research Laboratory

Dayton, OH

- Trained self-supervised vision models with distributed, containerized GPU workflows (2024); developed reject-option methods for translation (2023) and classifier training (2022).
- Built an OpenStreetMap-guided pipeline for temporal satellite imagery collection, published at the [ICCV 2021 workshop](#) with public code.

Publications (first author)

- *Learning When to Say “I Don’t Know”*. ISVC, 2022. Springer **Best Paper Award**.
- *Naturally Constrained Reject Option Classification*. Machine Vision and Applications, 2025.
- *Assessing the Role of Imagery in Multimodal Machine Translation*. WMT, 2024.
- *Return or Revise? Learning When Revision Helps Retrieval-Augmented QA*. arXiv:2609.30087, 2026 (preprint).
- *A Framework for Semi-Automatic Collection of Temporal Satellite Imagery for Analysis of Dynamic Regions*. ICCVW, 2021.

Teaching

Graduate Teaching Associate and Course Grader, Ohio State University

2023–2026

Led Excel labs (Spring 2026); held office hours and graded for Machine Learning and Foundations of NLP (2023–2025).

Skills and Service

Language: Python **Tools used:** PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, Slurm

ML engineering: LoRA fine-tuning, retrieval-augmented generation, distributed training, inference serving

Service: Reviewer for CVPR (2022, 2023), ICCV (2023), and ECCV (2022)